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On Air · Daniel

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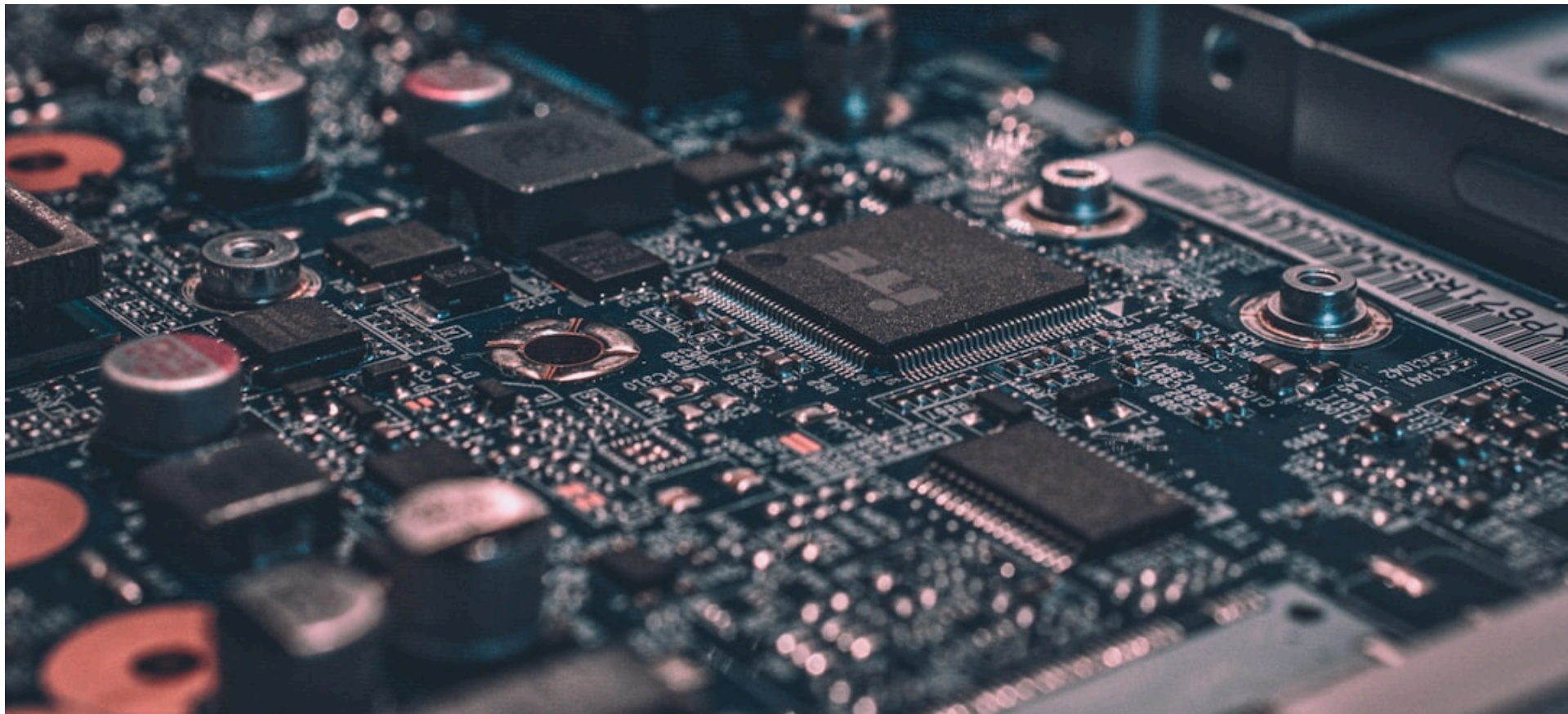


이번 호 기사

01	기술	Quantum Computing Threatens the World's Encryption	2
02	건강	The World Works Together Against Infectious Disease	3
03	기술	Who Is Liable When Self-Driving Cars Crash?	4
04	경제	Tariff Wars Push Up Prices for Consumers	5
05	세계	Europe Divided Over Who to Welcome	6
06	정치	Should Teenagers Have the Right to Vote?	7
07	교육	Shrinking School-Age Population Pressures Universities	8
08	환경	The Hidden Value Inside EV Batteries	9
09	환경	Cities Getting Hotter as Heat Days Increase	10
10	경제	Housing Shortage Deepens as Builder Workforce Shrinks	11

Quantum Computing Threatens the World's Encryption

By Daniel · 2026-09-14 · 310 words · L3



양자 컴퓨터와 암호 체계의 대비

Every time someone sends a password or makes an online payment, that data is protected by encryption — a system that scrambles information so that only the intended receiver can read it. For decades, this protection has been considered virtually unbreakable. Quantum computers, however, are now changing that assumption in a serious way.

Most encryption used today relies on the extreme difficulty of solving certain math problems, such as finding the prime factors of very large numbers. Classical computers would take thousands of years to crack these problems, which is exactly why the system works so well as a security tool.

Quantum computers operate on entirely different principles. Instead of processing information as

ones and zeros, they use quantum bits, or qubits, which can represent many states at the same time. This allows them to explore enormous numbers of possible solutions simultaneously, making them far faster at certain tasks than any classical machine.

Recent research suggests that a quantum computer with roughly half a million qubits could potentially break the elliptic curve encryption used by major cryptocurrencies like Bitcoin and Ethereum in just minutes. That timeline is far shorter than experts had previously estimated, raising new urgency around the issue.

Governments and technology organizations around the world have already begun working on solutions. The field known as post-quantum cryptography focuses on developing new

encryption methods that even quantum computers cannot break. The U.S. National Institute of Standards and Technology has been leading an international effort to standardize these new approaches.

The challenge is not only technical. Updating encryption across banking systems, government networks, and everyday devices will take considerable time and resources, so the transition must begin well before quantum computers reach full capability.

This is one of the most important problems in technology today, and solutions developed now will shape how digital information is protected for generations to come.

한글 요약

양자 컴퓨터는 큐비트를 활용해 수많은 해를 동시에 탐색할 수 있어, 기존 암호화 체계의 근간인 수학적 난제를 빠른 시간 안에 해독할 수 있는 잠재력을 지니고 있다. 최근 연구에 따르면 약 50만 큐비트 규모의 양자 컴퓨터가 비트코인·이더리움 등에 사용되는 타원 곡선 암호화를 단 몇 분 만에 무력화할 수 있는 것으로 분석되어, 위협의 현실화 시점이 기존 예상보다 훨씬 앞당겨질 수 있다는 우려가 커지고 있다. 이에 미국 국립표준기술연구소(NIST)를 중심으로 양자 컴퓨터도 해독할 수 없는 포스트 양자 암호화 기술의 국제 표준화 작업이 진행 중이다. 은행·정부·일상 기기 등 전 분야의 암호화 시스템 전환에는 막대한 시간과 자원이 소요되므로, 양자 컴퓨터가 완전한 성능에 도달하기 전부터 선제적인 대비를 시작해야 한다는 점이 강조되고 있다.

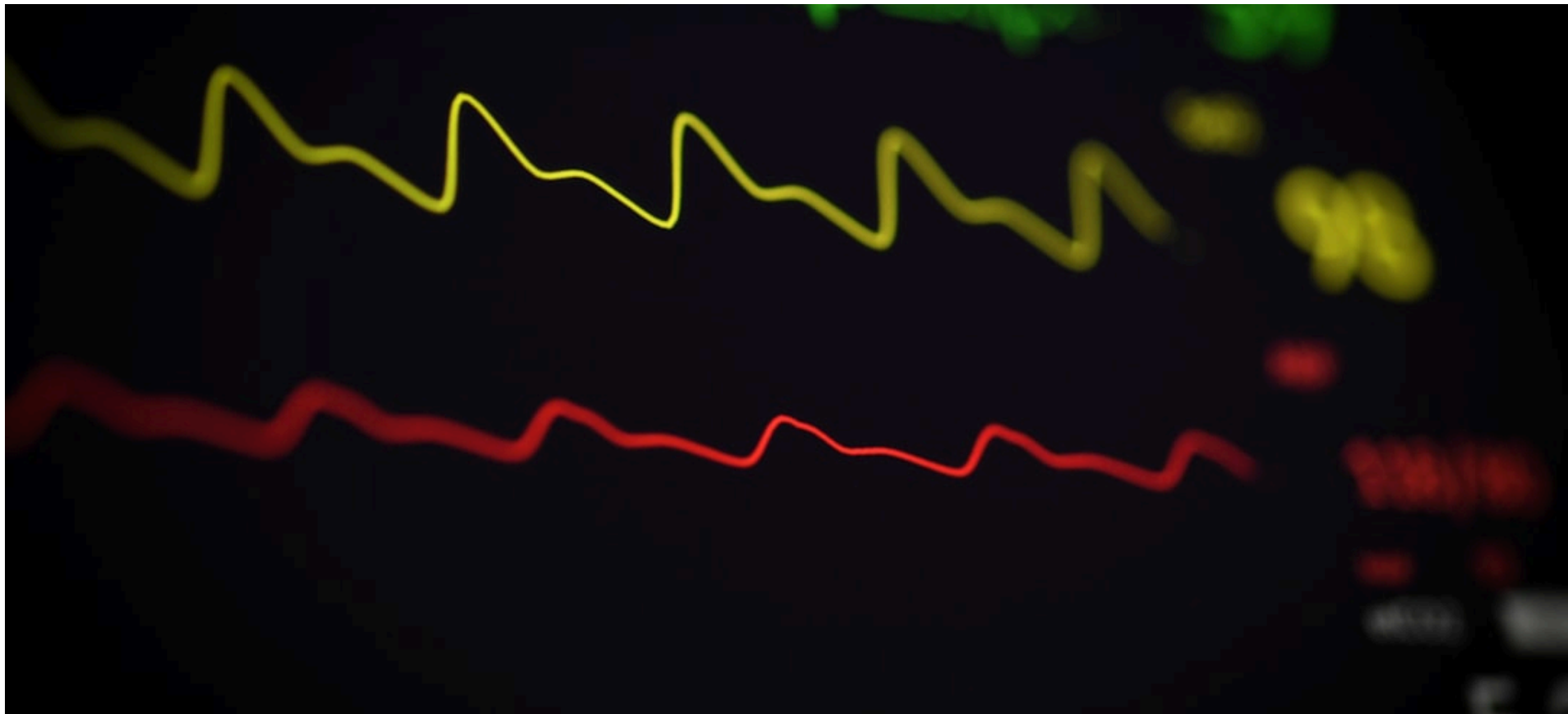
WORDS & MEANINGS

encryption 암호화
assumption 가정, 전제
virtually 사실상, 거의
prime factor 소인수
classical 전통적인, 기존의
qubit 양자 비트
simultaneously 동시에

elliptic curve 타원 곡선
cryptocurrency 암호화폐
urgency 긴박함, 시급함
post-quantum cryptography 양자 이후 암호화 기술
standardize 표준화하다
transition 전환, 이행
capability 능력, 역량

The World Works Together Against Infectious Disease

By Daniel · 2026-09-14 · 276 words · L2



감염병 감시 체계의 국제 공조

When a new infectious disease appears in one country, it can spread across borders within days. This is why international cooperation in disease surveillance has become one of the most important issues in global public health.

Disease surveillance means tracking and monitoring the spread of illnesses in a population. Governments and health agencies collect data on infection rates, identify unusual outbreaks, and share findings with other countries. The goal is to detect threats early — before they grow into full-scale epidemics or pandemics.

Several major organizations lead these efforts. The World Health Organization

(WHO) coordinates global disease monitoring and issues alerts when a serious outbreak is detected. Regional networks, such as the Africa Centres for Disease Control and Prevention (Africa CDC) and the European Centre for Disease Prevention and Control (ECDC), work alongside the WHO to gather local data and respond quickly to regional threats.

One lesser-known but valuable initiative is CORDS, or Connecting Organizations for Regional Disease Surveillance. It links regional surveillance networks around the world, helping them share information and best practices. Experts say that closing the gaps between isolated regional systems is

one of the biggest challenges in global health security.

Despite these efforts, significant problems remain. Many lower-income countries lack the resources to build strong surveillance systems, which creates blind spots in the global network. Health experts argue that wealthier nations must invest more in supporting these countries, since a weak link anywhere puts everyone at greater risk.

The COVID-19 pandemic showed how quickly a local outbreak can become a global crisis. Strengthening international surveillance cooperation is no longer optional — it is a shared responsibility that affects every country on earth.

한글 요약

감염병은 국경을 초월해 빠르게 확산될 수 있기 때문에, 국제 사회는 WHO, Africa CDC, ECDC 등 다양한 기관을 통해 질병 감시 협력 체계를 구축하고 있다. CORDS와 같은 이니셔티브는 각 지역 감시 네트워크를 연결하여 정보와 모범 사례를 공유함으로써 글로벌 보건 안보의 공백을 줄이는 데 기여하고 있다. 그러나 자원이 부족한 저소득 국가들은 충분한 감시 체계를 갖추지 못해 국제 네트워크에 취약한 사각지대가 발생하는 상황이며, 이는 부유한 국가들을 포함한 전 세계 모든 국가에 위협이 된다. 코로나19 팬데믹의 경험은 국제적 질병 감시 협력의 강화가 선택이 아닌 모든 국가의 공동 책임임을 분명히 보여주었다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

infectious 전염성의, 전파되는
surveillance 감시, 모니터링
cooperation 협력, 공조
outbreak 발생, 발병
epidemic 유행병, 전염병 대유행
pandemic 팬데믹, 세계적 유행병
monitor 감시하다, 추적하다

detect 탐지하다, 발견하다
coordinate 조율하다, 협력을 이끌다
initiative 계획, 추진 사업
isolated 고립된, 단절된
resources 자원, 재원
blind spot 맹점, 취약 지점
responsibility 책임

Who Is Liable When Self-Driving Cars Crash?

By Daniel · 2026-09-14 · 122 words · L1



자율주행 사고의 책임 소재

Self-driving technology is advancing rapidly, but accidents still happen. When they do, a key legal question arises: who is responsible — the driver, or the carmaker?

In 2025, a US jury ordered Tesla to pay over \$240 million after one of its Autopilot systems was linked to a serious crash. The case was significant because it held the manufacturer partly liable, not just the person behind the wheel. Courts are now under

pressure to update old traffic laws that were written before self-driving cars existed.

One major challenge is proving what went wrong. Investigators must examine vehicle data recorded before a crash to understand how the system behaved. As more countries adopt self-driving technology, clearer rules about liability will become increasingly important.

한글 요약

자율주행 기술이 빠르게 발전하는 가운데, 관련 사고가 발생했을 때 운전자와 제조사 중 누가 법적 책임을 지는가에 대한 논쟁이 심화되고 있다. 2025년 미국 배심원단은 테슬라의 오토파일럿 시스템이 연루된 사고에 대해 테슬라에 2억 4천만 달러 이상을 배상하도록 판결하며, 제조사의 책임을 인정하는 선례를 남겼다. 각국 법원은 자율주행차 출현 이전에 제정된 교통 법규를 현실에 맞게 개정해야 한다는 압박을 받고 있으며, 사고 원인 규명을 위해 차량에 기록된 데이터 분석이 핵심적인 역할을 하고 있다. 자율주행 기술의 전 세계적 확산에 따라 책임 소재에 관한 명확한 법적 기준 마련이 시급한 과제로 부상하고 있다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

liable 법적 책임이 있는

self-driving 자율주행의

manufacturer 제조사

jury 배심원단

Autopilot 자동 조종 시스템

significant 중요한, 의미 있는

liability 법적 책임

investigate 조사하다

vehicle 차량

adopt 채택하다

arises 발생하다

pressure 압력

existing 기존의

technology 기술

Tariff Wars Push Up Prices for Consumers

By Daniel · 2026-09-14 · 134 words · L1



관세 전쟁과 소비자 물가

The United States has imposed heavy tariffs on goods from many countries in recent years. Tariffs are taxes that importers pay when bringing foreign products into the country. When import costs rise, companies often pass those costs on to shoppers through higher prices.

Everyday items such as clothing, electronics, and furniture have become more expensive as a result. Some economists argue that American consumers are effectively paying a large share of the tariff costs,

since businesses raise retail prices rather than absorbing the extra expense themselves.

Rising consumer prices have added to concerns about inflation in the US economy. Analysts note that trade policy decisions can take months to fully work through supply chains before shoppers feel the impact. How long these higher prices will last depends largely on whether trade agreements are reached.

한글 요약

미국은 다수의 국가를 대상으로 고율의 관세를 부과하고 있으며, 이로 인해 수입 상품의 가격이 상승하고 있다. 기업들은 추가된 관세 비용을 소매 가격에 반영함으로써 사실상 소비자들이 그 부담을 떠안는 구조가 형성되고 있다. 의류, 전자제품, 가구 등 생활 밀접 품목의 가격 인상은 미국 내 인플레이션 우려를 심화시키는 요인으로 작용하고 있다. 향후 물가 안정 여부는 미국이 주요 교역국들과 무역 협정을 타결할 수 있는지에 달려 있다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

tariff 관세

impose 부과하다

importer 수입업자

foreign 외국의

pass on 전가하다, 떠넘기다

retail 소매의

absorb 흡수하다, 감당하다

inflation 인플레이션, 물가 상승

economist 경제학자

effectively 사실상, 실질적으로

supply chain 공급망

impact 영향, 충격

trade agreement 무역 협정

policy 정책

Europe Divided Over Who to Welcome

By Daniel · 2026-09-14 · 274 words · L2



난민 수용을 둘러싼 유럽의 분열

When large numbers of people flee war or persecution, they often head toward Europe. But not all European countries respond the same way — and those differences have become a serious political problem for the continent.

In recent years, anti-immigration parties have gained significant support across Europe. In countries such as France, Italy, Germany, and Sweden, these parties have won large shares of the vote by promising tighter border controls and stricter limits on asylum seekers. Their growing influence has made it harder for EU governments to agree on a shared approach to refugees.

The divisions go beyond simple politics. Analysts point to cultural and historical ties as a major factor in how countries decide whom to welcome. When Ukrainian refugees fled the conflict that began in 2022, many Western European nations opened their doors relatively quickly. However, refugees from the Middle East and Africa have often faced a much colder reception, leading critics to argue that race and religion play a role in these decisions.

Security concerns are another reason some governments resist taking in refugees. Officials in several countries argue that accepting large numbers of people without proper checks poses risks

to public safety. Some critics, however, argue that these concerns are sometimes used to justify unequal treatment of certain groups.

EU-wide coordination remains difficult. Countries disagree on how to share responsibility for processing asylum applications, and some nations have simply refused to accept refugee quotas set by Brussels.

Experts warn that these divisions could worsen as new crises develop. The situation in Lebanon, for example, raises fears of another large wave of displaced people heading toward Europe in the near future.

한글 요약

전쟁과 박해를 피해 유럽으로 향하는 난민에 대한 각국의 대응 방식이 달라지면서, 반이민 정당이 프랑스·독일·이탈리아 등 유럽 주요국에서 세력을 키우고 있다. 우크라이나 난민에게는 비교적 신속히 문호를 열었던 서유럽 국가들이 중동·아프리카 출신 난민에게는 냉담한 태도를 보여, 인종과 종교에 따른 차별적 대우라는 비판이 제기되고 있다. 망명 신청 처리 책임 분담을 둘러싼 EU 회원국 간 이견과 일부 국가의 할당량 거부로 인해 EU 차원의 공동 대응은 여전히 어려운 상황이다. 전문가들은 레바논 등지의 불안정한 정세가 새로운 대규모 난민 이동을 촉발할 경우 유럽 내 분열이 한층 심화될 수 있다고 경고하고 있다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

persecution 박해

asylum 망명, 피난처

anti-immigration 반이민의

border 국경

coordination 조율, 협력

refugee 난민

quota 할당량

reception 수용, 대접

discrimination 차별

flee 피하다, 도망치다

significant 상당한, 중요한

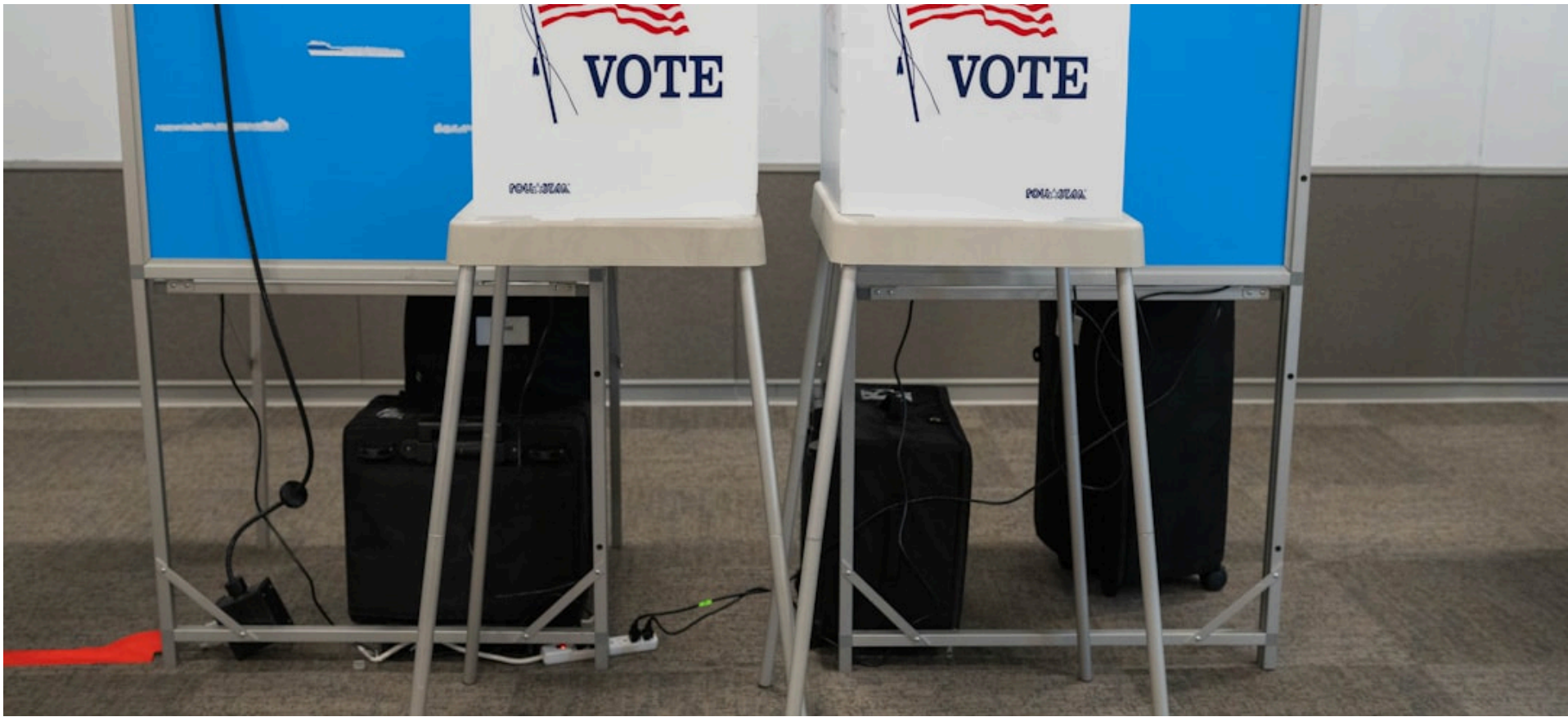
displaced 집을 잃은, 추방된

influence 영향력

justify 정당화하다

Should Teenagers Have the Right to Vote?

By Daniel · 2026-09-14 · 306 words · L3



선거 연령과 청년 정치 참여

Across many countries, the minimum voting age is 18. Yet a growing number of politicians, researchers, and young people themselves are asking whether that threshold should be lowered. The debate has gained attention in South Korea and beyond, raising important questions about democracy and youth participation.

In South Korea, the voting age was lowered from 19 to 18 a few years ago, allowing high school students to vote in national elections for the first time. Supporters say the change helped bring younger voices into the political process. Critics, however, argued that teenagers lack the life experience needed to make fully informed political decisions.

The debate is not unique to Korea. In several European countries, 16- and 17-year-olds are already allowed to vote in some or all elections. Supporters of lowering the age point out that young people are affected by government policies on education, climate, and employment, so they deserve a say in those decisions.

Opponents raise different concerns. Some argue that the brain continues to develop into the mid-20s, meaning younger voters may be more easily influenced by emotional or short-term thinking. Others question whether schools prepare teenagers adequately for civic participation.

One argument that appears in policy discussions is that people who vote early in

life may be more likely to develop consistent voting habits over time. Some researchers suggest that earlier engagement could lead to stronger long-term democratic participation.

Polling data also shows that many young adults feel disconnected from the political system. Some feel that voting does not lead to real change, which raises questions about how to make democracy feel more meaningful to younger generations.

The voting age debate ultimately touches on deeper questions about who counts as a full member of a democratic society. As more countries reconsider their rules, the conversation about youth political participation is likely to continue.

한글 요약

전 세계적으로 선거 연령 하향 조정에 대한 논의가 확산되고 있으며, 한국은 이미 선거 연령을 만 19세에서 만 18세로 낮춘 바 있다. 지지론자들은 청년들이 교육·기후·고용 등 정부 정책의 직접적인 영향을 받는 만큼 정치적 발언권을 가져야 한다고 주장하는 반면, 반대론자들은 뇌 발달 미완성과 시민 교육의 미비를 근거로 우려를 표명한다. 또한 일부 연구자들은 조기 투표 경험이 장기적으로 지속적인 민주주의 참여 습관을 형성할 수 있다고 제안한다. 선거 연령 논쟁은 결국 누가 민주주의 사회의 완전한 구성원으로 인정받아야 하는가라는 근본적인 질문과 맞닿아 있으며, 앞으로도 각국에서 계속될 것으로 전망된다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

threshold 기준점, 한계

participation 참여

democracy 민주주의

election 선거

informed 충분한 정보를 갖춘

civic 시민의, 공민의

consistent 일관된, 꾸준한

engagement 참여, 관여

formation 형성

policy 정책

opponent 반대자

disconnected 단절된, 유리된

adequately 충분히, 적절히

reconsider 재고하다, 다시 생각하다

Shrinking School-Age Population Pressures Universities

By Daniel · 2026-09-14 · 126 words · L1



학령 인구 감소와 대학 구조 조정

South Korea's university sector is facing serious pressure as the number of school-age young people continues to fall. Birth rates have dropped sharply over recent decades, meaning far fewer students are now entering higher education. Some universities are already struggling to fill their seats.

In response, many universities are cutting staff, merging departments, and reducing enrollment caps. Smaller regional schools have been hit especially

hard, and some have already closed. The South Korean government has encouraged universities to restructure in order to stay financially stable.

Experts warn that without major reform, dozens more institutions could shut down within the next decade. This situation raises important questions about how universities should adapt — and what kind of higher education system South Korea will need in the future.

한글 요약

출생률 급감으로 인한 학령인구 감소로 한국 대학들이 정원 미달 사태를 겪으며 심각한 위기에 직면하고 있다. 이에 따라 다수의 대학이 교직원 감축, 학과 통폐합, 정원 축소 등 구조조정에 나서고 있으며, 지방 소재 소규모 대학들의 피해가 특히 크다. 전문가들은 근본적인 개혁이 이루어지지 않을 경우 향후 10년 내에 수십 개의 대학이 추가로 폐교할 수 있다고 경고하고 있다. 이러한 위기는 한국이 미래의 고등교육 체계를 어떻게 재편해야 하는지에 대한 근본적인 물음을 사회에 던지고 있다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

sector 부문, 분야

pressure 압박, 압력

birth rate 출생률

enrollment 입학, 등록

higher education 고등 교육

struggle 어려움을 겪다

regional 지역의

restructure 구조 조정하다

financially 재정적으로

stable 안정적인

institution 기관, 교육 기관

reform 개혁

adapt 적응하다

decade 10년

The Hidden Value Inside EV Batteries

By Daniel · 2026-09-14 · 282 words · L2



전기차 배터리 원료의 재활용 경제

When an electric vehicle battery reaches the end of its life, it does not simply become waste. Inside each battery pack are significant quantities of lithium, cobalt, nickel, and manganese — materials that are both expensive and difficult to mine. Recovering these materials through recycling could reshape how the world thinks about critical mineral supply.

EV batteries typically last between eight and fifteen years. After that, their capacity drops too low for vehicle use, but they can still hold enough charge for smaller energy storage systems. Eventually, however, they must be processed, and the

question of how to do that profitably is one the industry is still working out.

The recycling process itself is technically complex. One widely used method, called hydrometallurgy, uses chemical solutions to dissolve and separate individual metals from battery materials. Studies show this approach can recover over 90 percent of key minerals when conditions are right. Another method, pyrometallurgy, uses high heat to extract metals but consumes more energy and recovers fewer materials.

The economics depend heavily on several factors. Transport costs, local labor rates, battery design, and the current market price of recovered metals all affect

whether a recycling operation makes money. When cobalt prices are high, recycling is clearly profitable. When prices fall, margins shrink quickly. Experts say consistent government policy — such as recycling mandates or tax credits — is often needed to keep the industry stable.

Globally, demand for EV batteries is expected to grow sharply through the 2030s, which means the volume of spent batteries will also rise. Analysts believe that building strong recycling systems now could reduce dependence on raw mineral imports and lower the overall environmental cost of the EV transition.

한글 요약

전기차 배터리에는 리튬, 코발트, 니켈, 망간 등 고가의 핵심 광물이 다량 포함되어 있어, 수명이 다한 배터리의 재활용이 글로벌 광물 공급 구조를 바꿀 잠재력을 지닌다. 습식 제련과 건식 제련 등 다양한 재활용 공정이 활용되고 있으며, 최적 조건에서는 핵심 광물의 90% 이상을 회수하는 것도 가능하다. 다만 재활용 사업의 수익성은 운송 비용, 노동 임금, 금속 시장 가격 등 여러 변수에 민감하게 반응하므로, 업계 안정을 위한 일관된 정부 정책이 뒷받침되어야 한다. 전문가들은 2030년대 전기차 수요 급증에 앞서 지금부터 강력한 재활용 체계를 갖추면, 원자재 수입 의존도를 낮추고 전기차 전환의 환경적 비용을 절감할 수 있다고 강조한다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

battery 배터리, 전지

cobalt 코발트 (금속 원소)

manganese 망간 (금속 원소)

recover 회수하다, 되찾다

capacity 용량, 수용력

hydrometallurgy 습식 제련법

dissolve 용해하다, 녹이다

extract 추출하다

margin 마진, 수익 차이

mandate 의무 규정, 지시

stable 안정적인

dependence 의존

transition 전환, 이행

mineral 광물

Cities Getting Hotter as Heat Days Increase

By Daniel · 2026-09-14 · 142 words · L1



폭염 일수 증가와 도시 설계

Extreme heat days are becoming more frequent around the world, and cities are feeling the effects more than rural areas. Dense buildings, concrete roads, and dark rooftops trap heat and push urban temperatures several degrees higher than surrounding areas. This effect is known as the 'urban heat island.'

City design plays a big role in how hot an area gets. Materials like asphalt and concrete absorb sunlight during the day and release it as heat at night. This

means cities cool down much more slowly, making hot spells longer and more dangerous for residents.

To fight rising temperatures, some cities are painting rooftops white, planting more trees, and using cooler building materials. These changes can lower local temperatures by a few degrees. As heat waves grow more intense due to climate change, experts say rethinking urban design is becoming an urgent priority.

한글 요약

전 세계적으로 극단적인 폭염 일수가 증가하면서, 콘크리트와 아스팔트 등의 건축 재료로 인해 열이 축적되는 도시 지역이 농촌보다 훨씬 높은 기온을 기록하는 '도시 열섬' 현상이 심화되고 있다. 도시는 낮 동안 흡수한 열을 밤에 방출하는 구조적 특성 탓에 냉각 속도가 느려, 폭염이 더 오래 지속되고 주민 건강에 더 큰 위협이 된다. 이에 일부 도시들은 옥상 백색 도색, 가로수 확충, 저열 흡수 건축 자재 도입 등을 통해 지역 기온을 낮추는 대책을 시행하고 있다. 기후 변화로 열파가 더욱 강렬해지는 가운데, 전문가들은 도시 설계 전반을 재검토하는 것이 시급한 우선 과제라고 강조한다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

extreme 극단적인, 심각한
frequent 빈번한, 잦은
rural 농촌의, 시골의
dense 빽빽한, 밀집한
urban 도시의
absorb 흡수하다
release 방출하다, 내보내다

resident 주민
asphalt 아스팔트
concrete 콘크리트
rooftop 옥상, 지붕 위
priority 우선순위
intense 강렬한, 심한
rethink 다시 생각하다, 재검토하다

Housing Shortage Deepens as Builder Workforce Shrinks

By Daniel · 2026-09-14 · 261 words · L2



주택 공급과 건설 인력 부족

In many countries, finding a home has become far harder than it was a decade ago. One major reason is that not enough houses are being built — and a key factor behind that slowdown is a growing shortage of construction workers.

The construction industry has struggled for years to attract enough people to fill its roles. Younger workers often prefer office jobs or careers in technology, leaving trades such as carpentry, plumbing, and concrete work short of candidates. When fewer workers are available, builders cannot take on as many projects, and the number of new

homes completed each year falls well below what the market needs.

The labor gap has worsened in recent years. The pandemic pushed many older skilled workers into early retirement, and those positions have not been refilled. Training new workers takes time — a qualified tradesperson typically needs several years of on-the-job experience — so the gap cannot be closed quickly.

Rising wages reflect the pressure. Construction companies have raised pay significantly to compete for a limited pool of workers, and those

higher costs are passed on to buyers and renters. Industry groups warn that without more investment in training programs, the workforce problem will continue to slow housing supply for years.

Some governments are responding by funding apprenticeship schemes and easing visa rules to allow more skilled migrants into the construction sector. Experts say these measures can help over the long term, but housing markets may remain tight for some time. For millions of people searching for affordable homes, the wait is far from over.

한글 요약

많은 국가에서 건설 노동자 부족이 심화되면서 신규 주택 공급이 시장 수요를 크게 밀돌고 있다. 팬데믹으로 인한 고령 숙련 노동자의 조기 은퇴와 청년층의 건설 직종 기피가 노동력 부족을 가속화했으며, 새로운 인력 양성에는 수년이 소요되어 단기간 내 해결이 어려운 상황이다. 인력 경쟁에 따른 임금 상승은 결국 건설 비용 증가로 이어져 주택 구매자와 임차인의 부담을 가중시키고 있다. 일부 정부가 도제 제도 지원과 비자 완화 등의 대책을 시행하고 있으나, 주택 시장의 공급 부족은 상당 기간 지속될 것으로 전망된다.

WORDS & MEANINGS

shortage 부족, 공급 부족
construction 건설, 건축
workforce 노동력, 인력
carpentry 목공, 목수 일
plumbing 배관 공사
candidate 지원자, 후보자
retire 은퇴하다

tradesperson 기술직 종사자
apprenticeship 도제 제도, 견습 과정
sector 부문, 분야
affordable 가격이 적당한, 저렴한
migrate 이주하다
tight (시장이) 빡빡한, 경쟁이 심한
investment 투자

